

Tyrannosauroids

Among the largest and most terrifying predators of all time were the tyrannosauroids (“tyrant lizards”). The first tyrannosauroids were small, possibly feathered dinosaurs, but over millions of years they evolved into giants, the biggest being *Tyrannosaurus* (next page). The giant tyrannosauroids had immensely powerful jaws lined with bone-crunching fangs, equipping them to butcher and consume almost any animal they came across.



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Key features

- Large skull and jaws relative to body size
- Small but powerful arms with only two or three fingers on each hand
- Long back legs built for running

When

Tyrannosauroids appeared in the Jurassic Period, 200 million years ago and died out at the end of the Cretaceous Period, 65 million years ago.



Tarbosaurus

TAR-bow-SORE-us

- **When** 70–65 million years ago (Late Cretaceous)
- **Fossil location** Mongolia, China
- **Habitat** Floodplains
- **Length** 39 ft (12 m)
- **Diet** Flesh

While *Tyrannosaurus* was terrorizing the wildlife of North America, its close relative *Tarbosaurus* was doing the same in China. *Tarbosaurus* was almost as big as its cousin but had a more slender skull and even tinier arms. It probably used the same feeding technique, crushing victims in its jaws and then tearing off chunks of flesh while holding the carcass down with its feet.